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OHamburgefonstiv Weight

Now Light 9pt

Sans cap typophile x height, clarendon ascender pica, legible typophile case ear typeface en punch baseline color sans serif em space. En dash bowl gestalt venetian, black humanist stroke extended ultra condensed script oblique hint en proof em letterpress typophile. Descender counter california job case clarendon hyphen kerning pair pica cap asterisk typophile, display clarendon thicks display bitmap modern italic em revival em dutch aldine gerald fat italic capital trajan descender baseline bezier display. Sans transitional typophile height, vernacular ascender pica, legible typophile case ear typeface en punch baseline color sans serif em space. En dash bowl gestalt venetian, black humanist stroke extended ultra condensed script oblique hint en proof em letterpress typophile. Descender counter california job case typophile hyphen transitional ampersand kerning pair pica vernacular, display baseline thicks display bitmap remix descender baseline bezier display font. Tuscan lower case face shift outline asterisk aldine parenthesis text italic lapidary serif inscriptional gerald. Sans transitional typophile x height, old style ascender pica, legible typophile case ear typeface en dash punch baseline color sans serif em space. En dash bowl gestalt venetian, black humanist stroke extended ultra condensed script oblique hint en proof em letterpress english vernacular. Descender counter california job case typophile hyphen transitional ampersand kerning pair pica esse molestie typophile, display baseline text bullet display bitmap.

At least 1⅓ of the clients came back. This is better than last year when we lost ¾ of our old clients.

1/2 1/3 1/4 1/8 3/8 2/3 7/8
½ ¼ ⅛ ⅜ ⅔ ⅞ frac OT

Now Light 6pt

Sans cap typophile x height, clarendon ascender pica, legible typophile case ear typeface en punch baseline color sans serif em space. En dash bowl gestalt venetian, black humanist stroke extended ultra condensed script oblique hint en proof em letterpress typophile.

Now Light 4pt

Sans cap typophile x height, clarendon ascender pica, legible typophile case ear typeface en punch baseline color sans serif em space. En dash bowl gestalt venetian, black humanist stroke extended ultra condensed script oblique hint en proof em letterpress typophile.

Text 12 Point

Bei jeder Schriftgestaltung wird der Grundcharakter eines Alphabets von einheitlichen Formmerkmalen der Buchstaben bestimmt. Er allein besagt noch nichts über das Niveau einer Druckschrift und die Qualität des Satzgefüges. Das Erscheinungsbild ist etwas Komplexes, das sich aus vielen Einzelheiten wie Form, Proportionen, Duktus, Rhythmus usw., bildet. Klingen alle gut zusammen, ist das Ganze mehr als die Summe seiner Teile. Für den Entwurf einer Schrift sind sicheres Form- und Stilgefühl die einzigen verlässlichen Grundlagen.

Text 10 Point Light TT

Bei jeder Schriftgestaltung wird der Grundcharakter eines Alphabets von einheitlichen Formmerkmalen der Buchstaben bestimmt. Er allein besagt noch nichts über das Niveau einer Druckschrift und die Qualität des Satzgefüges. Das Erscheinungsbild ist etwas Komplexes, das sich aus vielen Einzelheiten wie Form, Proportionen, Duktus, Rhythmus usw., bildet. Klingen alle gut zusammen, ist das Ganze mehr als die Summe seiner Teile. Für den Entwurf einer Schrift sind sicheres Form- und Stilgefühl die einzigen verlässlichen Grundlagen. Die weitere Bearbeitung bis zum fertigen Font erfordert eine Vielzahl von Kenntnissen und Erfahrungen, um die Schriftkonzeption zu realisieren. Auch bei der heutigen

Text 9 Point light

Bei jeder Schriftgestaltung wird der Grundcharakter eines Alphabets von einheitlichen Formmerkmalen der Buchstaben bestimmt. Er allein besagt noch nichts über das Niveau einer Druckschrift und die Qualität des Satzgefüges. Das Erscheinungsbild ist etwas Komplexes, das sich aus vielen Einzelheiten wie Form, Proportionen, Duktus, Rhythmus usw., bildet. Klingen alle gut zusammen, ist das Ganze mehr als die Summe seiner Teile. Für den Entwurf einer Schrift sind sicheres Form- und Stilgefühl die einzigen verlässlichen Grundlagen. Die weitere Bearbeitung bis zum fertigen Font erfordert eine Vielzahl von Kenntnissen und Erfahrungen, um die Schriftkonzeption zu realisieren. Auch bei der heutigen

Text 8 Point Light

Bei jeder Schriftgestaltung wird der Grundcharakter eines Alphabets von einheitlichen Formmerkmalen der Buchstaben bestimmt. Er allein besagt noch nichts über das Niveau einer Druckschrift und die Qualität des Satzgefüges. Das Erscheinungsbild ist etwas Komplexes, das sich aus vielen Einzelheiten wie Form, Proportionen, Duktus, Rhythmus usw., bildet. Klingen alle gut zusammen, ist das Ganze mehr als die Summe seiner Teile. Für den Entwurf einer Schrift sind sicheres Form- und Stilgefühl die einzigen verlässlichen Grundlagen. Die weitere Bearbeitung bis zum fertigen Font erfordert eine Vielzahl von Kenntnissen und Erfahrungen, um die Schriftkonzeption zu realisieren. Auch bei der heutigen

Text 6 Point Light

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Le répertoire BOLD peut être utilisé de deux manières:

1. Le grand public (quiconque possède un accès à Internet) peut effectuer une recherche dans le répertoire afin d'obtenir des informations sur les bibliothèques belges, en ce compris les sujets couverts par la bibliothèque.
 2. Si vous êtes bibliothécaire, vous pouvez enregistrer gratuitement votre bibliothèque dans BOLD. Les entrées enregistrées seront protégées à l'aide d'un mot de passe. Ceci vous permettra de mettre à jour vos informations à n'importe quel moment. Afin de garantir la qualité des données, les nouvelles entrées seront vérifiées par l'éditeur de BOLD avant d'être ajoutées dans la base de données.
- La bibliothèque doit être située en Belgique
 - Le bibliothèque doit être accessible au public d'une manière ou d'une autre (accès libre, accès limité à certaines catégories d'utilisateurs, accès uniquement sur rendez-vous). Les bibliothèques qui n'autorisent en aucune manière l'accès à des utilisateurs extérieurs à l'institution ne seront pas incluses dans BOLD.

verkündet die Generalversammlung diese Allgemeine Erklärung der Menschenrechte als das von allen Völkern und Nationen zu erreichende gemeinsame Ideal, damit jeder einzelne und alle Organe der Gesellschaft sich diese Erklärung stets gegenwärtig halten und sich bemühen, durch Unterricht und Erziehung die Achtung vor diesen Rechten und Freiheiten zu fördern und durch fortschreitende nationale und internationale Maßnahmen ihre allgemeine und tatsächliche Anerkennung und Einhaltung durch die Bevölkerung der Mitgliedstaaten selbst wie auch durch die Bevölkerung der ihrer Hoheitsgewalt unterstehenden Gebiete zu gewährleisten.

Artikel 1

Alle Menschen sind frei und gleich an Würde und Rechten geboren. Sie sind mit Vernunft und Gewissen begabt und sollen einander im Geist der Brüderlichkeit begegnen.

Artikel 2

Jeder hat Anspruch auf die in dieser Erklärung

verkündeten Rechte und Freiheiten ohne irgendeinen Unterschied, etwa nach Rasse, Hautfarbe, Geschlecht, Sprache, Religion, politischer oder sonstiger Überzeugung, nationaler oder sozialer Herkunft, Vermögen, Geburt oder sonstigem Stand.

Des weiteren darf kein Unterschied gemacht werden auf Grund der politischen, rechtlichen oder internationalen Stellung des Landes oder Gebiets, dem eine Person angehört, gleichgültig ob dieses unabhängig ist, unter Treuhandschaft steht, keine Selbstregierung besitzt oder sonst in seiner Souveränität eingeschränkt ist.

Italia

Madamina! Il catalogo è questo, Delle belle, che amò il padron mio; un catalogo egli è che ho fatt'io. Osservate, leggete con me! In Italia seicento e quaranta, In Almagna suecento tre l'una; Cento in Francia, in Turchia novant'una, Ma, ma in Ispagna, son già mille e tre! V'han fra queste contadine, cameriere cittadine; v'han contesse, baronesse, marchesane, principesse, e v'han donne d'ogni grado, d'ogni forma d'ogni età. Nella bionda, egli ha l'usanza di lodar la gentilezza, nella bruna la costanza, nella bianca la dolcezza! Vuol d'inverno la grassotta, vuol d'estate la magrotta; È la grande, maestosa; La piccina, ognor vezzosa. Delle vecchie fa conquista pel piacere di porle in lista. Sua passione predominante è la giovin principiante Non si picca, se sia ricca Se sia brutta, se sia bella; Purché porti la gonnella, voi sapete quel che fa!

Všeobecnou deklaraci lidských práv

jakožto společný cíl pro všechny národy a všechny státy za tím účelem, aby se každý jednotlivec a každý orgán společnosti, maje tuto deklaraci stále na mysli, snažil vyučováním a výchovou rozšířit úctu k těmto právům a svobodám azajistit postupnými opatřeními vnitrostátními i mezinárodními jejich všeobecné a účinné uznávání a zachovávání jak mezi lidem členských států samých, tak i mezi lidem území, jež jsou pod jejich pravomocí.

Článek 1

Všichni lidé rodí se svobodní a sobě rovní co do důstojnosti a práv. Jsou nadáni rozumem a svědomím a mají spolu jednat v duchu bratrství.

Článek 2

Každý má všechna práva a všechny svobody, stanovené touto deklarací, bez jakéhokoli rozlišování, zejména podle rasy, barvy, pohlaví, jazyka, náboženství, politického nebo jiného smýšlení, národnostního nebo sociálního původu, majetku, rodu nebo jiného postavení.

ŽÁDNÝ ROZDÍL NEBUDE DÁLE ČINĚN Z DŮVODU POLITICKÉHO, PRÁVNÍHO NEBO MEZINÁRODNÍHO POSTAVENÍ ZEMĚ NEBO ÚZEMÍ, K NIMŽ URČITÁ OSOBA PŘÍSLUŠÍ, AŽ JDE O ZEMI NEBO ÚZEMÍ NEZÁVISLÉ NEBO POD PORUČENSTVÍM, NESAMOSPRÁVNÉ NEBO PODROBNĚ JAKÉMUKOLI JINÉMU OMEZENÍ SUVERENITY.

Článek 3

KAŽDÝ MÁ PRÁVO NA ŽIVOT, SVOBODU A OSOBNÍ BEZPEČNOST.

PRZETO ZGROMADZENIE OGÓLNE

Ogłasza Uroczyscie niniejszą Powszechną Deklarację Praw Człowieka jako wspólny najwyższy cel wszystkich ludów i wszystkich narodów, aby wszyscy ludzie i wszystkie organy społeczeństwa – mając stale w pamięci niniejszą Deklarację – dążyły w drodze nauczania i wychowywania do rozwijania poszanowania tych praw i wolności i aby zapewniły za pomocą postępowych środków o zasięgu krajowym i międzynarodowym powszechnie i skuteczne uznanie i stosowanie tej Deklaracji zarówno wśród narodów Państw Członkowskich, jak i wśród narodów zamieszkujących obszary podległe ich władzy.

Artykuł 1

Wszyscy ludzie rodzą się wolni i równi pod względem swej godności i swych praw. Są oni obdarzeni rozumem i sumieniem i powinni postępować wobec innych w duchu braterstwa.

Artykuł 2

Każdy człowiek posiada wszystkie prawa i wolności zawarte w niniejszej Deklaracji bez względu na jakiegokolwiek różnice rasy, koloru, płci, języka, wyznania, poglądów politycznych i innych, narodowości, pochodzenia społecznego, majątku, urodzenia lub jakiegokolwiek innego stanu.

NIE WOLNO PONADTO CZYNIĆ ŻADNEJ RÓŻNICY W ZALEŻNOŚCI OD SYTUACJI POLITYCZNEJ, PRAWNEJ LUB MIĘDZYNARODOWEJ KRAJU LUB OBSZARU, DO KTÓREGO DANA OSOBA PRZYNALEŻY, BEZ WZGLĘDU NA TO, CZY DANY KRAJ LUB OBSZAR JEST NIEPODLEGŁY, CZY TEŻ PODLEGA SYSTEMOWI POWIERNICTWA, NIE RZĄDZI SIĘ SAMODZIELNIE LUB JEST W JAKIKOLWIEK SPOSÓB OGRANICZONY W SWEJ NIEPODLEGŁOŚCI.

Artykuł 3

KAŻDY CZŁOWIEK MA PRAWO DO ŻYCIA, WOLNOŚCI I BEZPIECZEŃSTWA SWEJ OSOBY.

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graphic design

thorough thorough

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WOMAN MAN BIRTH
DEATH INFINITY

GOD SAVE OUR SOULS

WEALTH MIGHT WIN

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flflflflriti eye eye sir!

NOW LIGHT SMALL CAPS 9PT
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NOW LIGHT SMALL CAPS 10PT
SANS CAP TYPOPHILE X HEIGHT, CLARENDON ASCENDER PICA, LEGIBLE TYPOPHILE CASE EAR TYPEFACE EN PUNCH BASELINE COLOR SANS SERIF EM SPACE. EN DASH BOWL GESTALT VENETIAN, BLACK HUMANIST STROKE EXTENDED ULTRA CONDENSED SCRIPT OBLIQUE HINT EN PROOF EM LETTERPRESS TYPOPHILE. DESCENDER COUNTER CALIFORNIA JOB CASE CLARENDON HYPHEN KERNING PAIR PICA CAP ASTERISK TYPOPHILE, DISPLAY CLARENDON THICKS DISPLAY BITMAP MODERN ITALIC EM REVIVAL EM DUTCH ALDINE GERALDE FAT ITALIC CAPITAL TRAJAN DESCENDER BASELINE BEZIER DISPLAY. SANS TRANSITIONAL TYPOPHILE HEIGHT, VERNACULAR ASCENDER PICA, LEGIBLE TYPOPHILE CASE EAR TYPEFACE EN PUNCH BASELINE COLOR SANS SERIF EM SPACE. EN DASH BOWL GESTALT VENETIAN, BLACK HUMANIST STROKE EXTENDED ULTRA CONDENSED SCRIPT OBLIQUE HINT EN PROOF EM LETTERPRESS TYPOPHILE. DESCENDER COUNTER CALIFORNIA JOB CASE TYPOPHILE HYPHEN TRANSITIONAL AMPERSAND KERNING PAIR PICA VERNACULAR, DISPLAY BASELINE THICKS DISPLAY BITMAP REMIX DESCENDER BASELINE BEZIER DISPLAY FONT. TUSCAN LOWER CASE FACE SHIFT OUTLINE ASTERISK ALDINE PARENTHESIS TEXT ITALIC LAPIDARY SERIF INSCRIPTIONAL GERALDE. SANS TRANSITIONAL TYPOPHILE X HEIGHT, OLD STYLE ASCENDER PICA, LEGIBLE TYPOPHILE CASE EAR TYPEFACE EN DASH PUNCH BASELINE COLOR SANS SERIF EM SPACE. EN DASH BOWL GESTALT VENETIAN, BLACK HUMANIST STROKE EXTENDED ULTRA CONDENSED SCRIPT OBLIQUE HINT EN PROOF EM LETTERPRESS ENGLISH VERNACULAR. DESCENDER COUNTER CALIFORNIA JOB CASE TYPOPHILE HYPHEN TRANSITIONAL AMPERSAND KERNING PAIR PICA ESSE MOLESTIE TYPOPHILE, DISPLAY BASELINE TEXT BULLET DISPLAY BITMAP.

NOW LIGHT SMALL CAPS 11PT
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HAMBURGEFONSTIV

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ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

a quick brown fox jumps over

the lazy dog. A Quick Brown

Fox Jumps Over The Lazy Dog.

A QUICK BROWN FOX JUMPS

Hamburgefonstiv

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• H a H b H c H d H e H f H g H h H i H j H k H l H m H n H o H p
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• f f a f f b f f c f f d f f e f f f f g f f h f f i f f j f f k f f l f f m f f n f f o f f p f f q f f
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d o e o f o g o h o i o j o k o l o m o n o o p o q o r o s o t o u o v o w o x o y o z o • v a v b v c v d v e v f v g v h v i v j v k v l v m v n v o v p v q v r v s v t v u v v v w v x v y v z v • r a r b r c r d r e r f r g r h r i r j r k r l r m r n r o r p r q r r r s r t r u r v r w r x r y r z r • t a t b t c t d t e t f t g t h t i t j t k t l t m t n t o t p t q t r t s t t t u t v t w t x t y t z t • t t a t t b t t c t t d t t e t t f t g t t h t t i t t j t t k t t l t t m t t n t t o t t p t t q t t r t t s t t t t u t t v t t w t t x t t y t t z t • g g a g g b g g c g g d g g e g g f g g g g h g g i g g j g g k g g l g g m g g n g g o g g p g g q g g r g g s g g t g g u g g v g g w g g x g g y g g z g g • z z a z z b z z c z z d z z e z z z f z z g z z h z z i z z j z z k z z l z z m z z n z z o z z p z z q z z r z z s z z t z z u z z v z z w z z x z z y z z z z z • f f a f f b f f c f f d f f e f f f f g f f h f f i f f j f f k f f l f f m f f n f f o f f p f f q f f r f f s f f t f f u f f v f f w f f x f f y f f z f f • f f a f f b f f c f f d f f e f f f f f f l f f l d f f l e f f l f f l g f f l h f f l i f f l j f f l k f f l l f f l m f f l n f f l o f f l p f f l q f f l r f f l s f f l t f f l u f f l v f f l w f f l x f f l y f f l z f f l • s i a s i b s i c s i d s i e s i f s i g s i h s i i s i j s i k s i l s i m s i n s i o s i p s i q s i r s i s s i t s i u s i v s i w s i x s i y s i z s i • a i a a i b a i c a i d a i e a i f a i g a i h a i i a i j a i k a i l a i m a i n a i o a i p a i q a i r a i s a i t a i u a i v a i w a i x a i y a i z a i • t i a t i b t i c t i d t i e t i f t i g t i h t i i t i j t i k t i l t i m t i n t i o t i p t i q t i r t i s t i t t i u t i v t i w t i x t i y t i z t i • . a . b . c . d . e . f . g . h . i . j . k . l . m . n . o . p . q . r . s . t . u . v . w . x . y . z . • , a , b , c , d , e , f , g , h , i , j , k , l , m , n , o , p , q , r , s , t , u , v , w , x , y , z , • ' a ' ' b ' ' c ' ' d ' ' e ' ' f ' ' g ' ' h ' ' i ' ' j ' ' k ' ' l ' ' m ' ' n ' ' o ' ' p ' ' q ' ' r ' ' s ' ' t ' ' u ' ' v ' ' w ' ' x ' ' y ' ' z ' • " a " " b " " c " " d " " e " " f " " g " " h " " i " " j " " k " " l " " m " " n " " o " " p " " q " " r " " s " " t " " u " " v " " w " " x " " y " " z " • . A . B . C . D . E . F . G . H . I . J . K . L . M . N . O . P . Q . R . S . T . U . V . W . X . Y . Z . • , A , B , C , D , E , F , G , H , I , J , K , L , M , N , O , P , Q , R , S , T , U , V , W , X , Y , Z , • ' A ' ' B ' ' C ' ' D ' ' E ' ' F ' ' G ' ' H ' ' I ' ' J ' ' K ' ' L ' ' M ' ' N ' ' O ' ' P ' ' Q ' ' R ' ' S ' ' T ' ' U ' ' V ' ' W ' ' X ' ' Y ' ' Z ' • " A " " B " " C " " D " " E " " F " " G " " H " " I " " J " " K " " L " " M " " N " " O " " P " " Q " " R " " S " " T " " U "

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dot-font: Does Graphic Design Need Nudging? The most recent issue of *Emigre*, "Nudging Graphic Design," is full of essays on the nature of design and how to think about it. What, if anything, should graphic designers be doing differently?

By John D. Berry, creativepro.com contributing editor
Monday, June 7, 2004

Related Books:

Faces on the Edge: Type in the Digital Age

Emigre : Graphic Design into the Digital Realm

Rudy VanderLans, in his editorial in "Emigre" No. 66, describes his ideal for critical writing about graphic design: "My own vision of the perfect writer is of one who can write engagingly, has a distinct personal style, gives us new insights into our profession, and writes in a way that designers (and outsiders alike) can understand, yet challenges them intellectually."

Well, yes. That sounds about right. Unfortunately, a few of the writers who contribute essays or interviews to this issue of "Emigre" live up to it, except sporadically. Is it so hard to write coherently and thoughtfully, without succumbing to rote and cant? Apparently it is.

Writers about graphic design, like writers about the arts, literature, music, architecture, or almost any kind of intellectual activity, reinvent the wheel constantly. The wheel is a fascinating thing to make, which is why we build it over and over again, but once you've gone through one revolution, it's boring and repetitive to watch another one roll by. The essays in this issue (and the earlier essays they're responding to, I suspect) are full of cries of alarm, insisting urgently that Things Must Change, and searching desperately for an orthodoxy to disavow. Some of the writers seem to think that salvation comes from the academy—that is, established academic programs—while others view the academy as the enemy.

I'm generalizing, of course. But it comes naturally; after reading through this issue, how could I not? I approached "Emigre" No. 66 with high hopes; it looked like a potentially invigorating collection of essays, with some intelligent observation of contemporary graphic design and some lively ideas about where it might go. But after finishing all the essays, I found them blending together, with too many of them simply

leaving an impression of poses struck at a student/faculty cocktail party. And now I'm only one step away from doing the same thing myself. It's dispiriting.

The Good Stuff

This kind of discouragement must be what created the slightly sour tone of Jeff Keedy's "Dumb Ideas," one of the more incisive pieces in the issue. I recognized the tone, because it's one I can succumb to myself, in similar circumstances. He's right on target with some of his short rants, especially against the his final "dumb idea": "What is needed in design is a new..." The fact that some of the "dumb ideas" are mutually contradictory statements makes it clear that what he's really annoyed by is simpleminded, one-track thinking.

The best article is Lorraine Wild's "Castles Made of Sand," which is a response to Rick Poyner's recent book, "No More Rules: Graphic Design and Postmodernism." (Another essay in this issue, "Postmodern Postmortem" by Sam Potts, is also a response to Poyner's book.) The reason it's good is that Wild engages her subject personally and directly, writing from her own experience and showing how ideas grow out of events in people's lives, not out of some nebulous breeding ground of theory and Platonic ideals. Wild criticizes Poyner for not giving enough context, for not taking into account everything else that was going on in the world during the time he's talking about (the 1980s and 1990s); since I have yet to read Poyner's book, I can't judge whether Wild's criticism of it is justified, but it's a reasonable thing to ask for.

In recounting some of her own reactions to graphic design in the early '80s, Wild expresses something that seems to exercise most of the writers in this issue: the frustration of being offered modernism as a fait accompli, an answer to all the questions you haven't even asked yet. "Could you be forgiven, perhaps, for beginning to suspect that what you were being taught was not actually modernism at all, but habit? Or bizarre fraternity rituals?"

The argument with modernism is very much like the argument the modernists had with their own predecessors: we're young, we're new, we want to change the world, and to do so, we've got to smash whatever came before. And now the same skeptical eye is being turned on modernism's successor, postmodernism. It happens with every status quo; there's always a bunch of young would-be revolutionaries who want to overturn it. They look at what's being produced and say, quite rightly, "Most of this is junk!" But most of what's produced in any field, new or old, is junk. Revolutionary idealism doesn't guarantee better work; neither does adherence to accepted rules.

The Things of Everyday Design

Since graphic design is the visual organization of the elements of our environment, it makes sense that the common

standard should be clear and straightforward. But it also has to be easy to implement. When the young Jan Tschichold was urging the standards of the New Typography on German printers, he wrote for the people who actually did the work, those who were responsible for the finished product; and when he later thought better of this effort, it was partly because he felt that the techniques of the New Typography were too demanding for ordinary printers to put into effect. You could almost say that people "print best what they print most"; that is, what ordinary people, whether they're German printers in the 1920s or American office workers in the 2000s, are most likely to turn out on a piece of paper is what they're used to doing, and seeing.

If they're used to seeing something complicated and ornate, that's what they'll make, or try to make; if they're used to seeing something simple and unadorned, they'll aim for that. (If they're used to Fraktur, they'll use it; if they're used to Helvetica, they'll use that.) It takes great skill to practice graphic design well, whether it's a circus poster or the most strictly gridded Swiss-style info-design.

I can't help thinking of my friend Sam Hamill's observation about academic poets. Sam, a very non-academic poet himself, had done his share of railing against the rote-learning and mediocrity that comes so often out of college writing workshops, but he also drew a parallel with ancient China, which produced some of the world's greatest poets. The Chinese bureaucracy was based on an examination system that included literature as a major component; every bureaucrat was capable of composing a poem, and frequently did so. Of course most of the poems were mediocre, but they were at least formally competent. There's something to be said, Sam pointed out, for a system that produces a reasonable level of skill and discipline on a widespread basis. Such a system won't create genius, but none ever does; genius springs up out of whatever soil it finds, unpredictably.

Graves of Academe

In this issue of "Emigre," some of the writers seem to think that the only alternative to graphic design as a hard-headed, money-based business is graphic design as an academic discipline. They're confusing critical writing with academic writing, and complexity with substance. The best critics are direct and clear; they also delve deep, but their digging implement is an incisive mind, not a finely honed theory.

Even Rudy VanderLans falls into this trap, as he compares the off-the-cuff writing on graphic-design weblogs with the dense prose of the academy. "Academic writing tends to be more difficult to read, as it tackles complex ideas, or looks at seemingly simple ideas and shows us that they're not. In terms of writing, it stands at the polar opposite of blog chatter." But complex language does not guarantee complex ideas; sometimes it obscures them.

The dialog can, and should, go on. Graphic design has an effect on the world, and it's a useful way of thinking about the stew of information that we live in. There is absolutely no point in dealing with graphic design in isolation, whether you're studying it or practicing it. Empty theorizing is as deadening to the soul as a stubborn insistence that only the commercial transaction matters. I applaud "Emigre"'s willingness to get designers talking to each other; I just wish more of them had something enlightening to say.

Forget the manifestoes, forget the baricades, forget the theories. Just use your common sense, do a good job, and aim for the stars.